

LESSON 19

Doctrine, Reproof, Correction, Training—What It All Means

8: Studying the Bible

Executive Summary

Paul tells Timothy that all Scripture is profitable for four specific purposes: doctrine (teaches the path God designs), reproof (reveals when we've stepped off the path), correction (guides us back to the right path), and training in righteousness (keeps us walking on the path). This four-fold pattern is the framework for a lifetime of Bible study.

Key Terms

Doctrine	Biblical truth organized and clearly stated so that believers know what to believe and how to live.
Reproof	Scripture's work of exposing error and showing where belief or behavior has departed from God's path.
Correction	Scripture's work of restoring wrong belief or conduct to the path God has revealed.
Righteousness	Conformity to God's holy character and standard, received in Christ and increasingly practiced by believers.

Key Verses

English Standard Version (ESV)

2 Timothy 3:16-17

16 All Scripture is breathed out by God and profitable for teaching, for reproof, for correction, and for training in righteousness, 17 that the man of God may be complete, equipped for every good work.

James 1:22

22 But be doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving yourselves.

Application Questions

1. Apply the four purposes in 2 Timothy 3:16 to one biblical passage: what does it teach, expose, correct, and train you to practice?

2. What is the difference between reproof that identifies departure from God's path and correction that guides a person back to it?

3. Where are you hearing biblical truth without becoming the kind of doer described in James 1:22?

4. Choose one correction from Scripture that you will turn into repeated training in righteousness this week. What will repetition look like?
